

Saul D. Bid

Your grievance with Grant

Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Your other secret

You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant and I disagreed over an old sale. He knew something awkward about it and enjoyed reminding me. I wanted a settlement, preferably without an audience.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the auction catalogue desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

I stayed at the auction catalogue desk from 6:40 to 6:49. An on-duty attendant checked my identity and watched me there the whole time. I did not enter the Donor Salon.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the auction catalogue desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

The staff record confirms I stayed at the auction catalogue desk for the whole window. It clears my whereabouts. It does not clear anyone else, and I cannot speak for what another guest did.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.